

Introduction to the “Text Flow”

You have learned how to do a Sentence Flow, a tool which is designed to grammatically break down a *sentence* into each individual word. When you do exegesis, however, you will need to deal with passages much longer than one sentence. Doing a Sentence Flow on every sentence may not be necessary and can be quite laborious. You should continue to use sentence flowing when needed to help you understand the grammar of complex sentences but, going forward, text flowing will be your primary tool for breaking down a text.

A **Text Flow** is a tool designed to break down a whole Greek text or passage into individual sentences and clauses. Its purpose is to help the exegete visually simplify a text in preparation for further exegesis, including *Discourse Analysis*. Once you have completed a Text Flow, you will have your whole passage laid out clause-by-clause. This will help you to be methodical in translating the text. It will help you to more quickly identify how each clause relates to the others. Another benefit to text flowing is that, unlike sentence flowing, you are preserving the original word order of the text. A Text Flow may serve, then, as a good “base text” for making all kinds of exegetical observations and performing different kinds of exegetical analyses, some of which you will learn in Greek III, Hermeneutics, and other upper-level NT classes.

In a Text Flow, the basic distinction you will make is one that you should already know well. It is simply the distinction between “independent” and “dependent” (i.e., subordinate) clauses. Another way to describe the relationship between clauses is with the ideas of “parataxis” (when clauses are *coordinated*) and “hypotaxis” (when one or more clause is *subordinated* to another). You know that a clause is a grammatical unit that consists of a subject and a predicate. Remember that sometimes the subject or the predicate is assumed. See the instructions on the following page for identifying independent and dependent clauses in a Text Flow.

Instructions for Creating a Text Flow

Flow the text by putting each *clause* on a new line, and *indenting* the dependent (i.e., subordinate) clauses. Work your way through a Greek text from beginning to end, using “enter” and “tab” keys. Use the following Text Flow Guidelines to help you through the process:

1. Every *independent* clause goes on a new line and is left-justified. Every *dependent* clause goes on a new line and is indented *above or below* the clause it modifies (preserving the original word order).

- a. Sometimes dependent clauses will be subordinated to other dependent clauses. Sometimes multiple dependent clauses will be lined up under the same independent clause. When an indented (dependent) clause has independent clauses above *and* below it, context tells you which independent clause it modifies. If a clause runs over onto the next line, just align the second line with the first (see **bold** below):

καὶ ἔσεσθέ μου μάρτυρες ἔν τε Ἱερουσαλὴμ καὶ [ἐν] πάσῃ τῇ Ἰουδαίᾳ καὶ
Σαμαρείᾳ καὶ ἕως ἐσχάτου τῆς γῆς. (Acts 1:8)

- b. **Examples:**

Independent-dependent:

καὶ ἰδοὺ σεισμὸς (earthquake) μέγας ἐγένετο ἐν τῇ θαλάσσῃ,
ὥστε τὸ πλοῖον καλύπτεσθαι (covered) ὑπὸ τῶν κυμάτων, (Matt
8:24)

Dependent-independent:

ἐπεὶ πολλοὶ καυχῶνται κατὰ σάρκα,
κἀγὼ καυχῆσομαι (2 Cor 11:18)

2. Put adverbial participles and attendant circumstance participles (with their subjects, objects, and modifiers) on their own line and indent (e.g., “*After he came*, he entered,” “he won *by running fast*” – the italicized portions are dependent clauses). Examples:

καὶ **προσελθόντες**
ἤγειραν αὐτὸν (Matt 8:25)

οἱ δὲ ἄνθρωποι ἐθαύμασαν
λέγοντες·
... (Matt 8:27)

Καὶ **ἐμβάντι** αὐτῷ εἰς τὸ πλοῖον
ἠκολούθησαν αὐτῷ οἱ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ. (Matt 8:23)

3. Do *not* put substantival, attributive, or periphrastic participles on a separate line.

Καὶ ἐλθόντος αὐτοῦ εἰς τὸ πέραν εἰς τὴν χώραν τῶν Γαδαρηνῶν
ὑπὴντησαν αὐτῷ δύο **δαιμονιζόμενοι** (Matt 8:28)

Ἀποκαλύπτεται ὁργὴ θεοῦ ἐπὶ ἀδικίαν ἀνθρώπων **τῶν** τὴν ἀλήθειαν **κατεχόντων** (Rom 1:18)

4. Put adverbial infinitives (purpose, result, time, cause, means), together with their subjects, objects, and modifiers, on a new line and indent (e.g., He ran *to meet her at the station* – purpose).

ἀπήγαγον αὐτὸν
εἰς τὸ **σταυρῶσαι** (Matt 27:31)

μετὰ δὲ τὸ **παραδοθῆναι** τὸν Ἰωάννην
ἦλθεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς εἰς τὴν Γαλιλαίαν (Mark 1:14)

5. Do *not* put substantival, expegetical, or complementary infinitives (“he is able *to dig*”) on a new line.

Γινώσκειν δὲ ὑμᾶς βούλομαι, ἀδελφοί,
ὅτι... (Phil 1:12)

θεὸς γάρ ἐστιν ὁ ἐνεργῶν ἐν ὑμῖν καὶ **τὸ θέλειν** καὶ **τὸ ἐνεργεῖν** ὑπὲρ τῆς εὐδοκίας
(Phil 2:13)

6. A protasis (“if...”) is indented (dependent), and an apodosis (“then...”) is independent.

ἐὰν ὁμολογῶμεν τὰς ἀμαρτίας ἡμῶν,
πιστός ἐστιν καὶ δίκαιος,
ἵνα ἀφῇ ἡμῖν τὰς ἀμαρτίας (1 John 1:9)

7. Do not put verbal interjections (e.g., ἰδοῦ – “Behold!”) on their own line.

ἰδοῦ ἐξῆλθεν ὁ σπείρων (Mark 4:3)

καὶ **ἰδοῦ** φωνὴ ἐκ τῶν οὐρανῶν
λέγουσα
οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ υἱός μου ὁ ἀγαπητός, (Matt 3:17)

But when εἶδον (ἰδοῦ\ἰδε) is *not* an interjection, flow as you normally would:

λέγει αὐτῷ ὁ Φίλιππος·
ἔρχου

καὶ ἴδε. (John 1:46)

8. Discourse clauses (direct or indirect): even if it is independent, indent it under the clause that introduces it. Subsequent clauses are either lined up (if independent) or indented (if dependent); e.g., he answered and said, “*I’ve gone.*” They knew *that he was killed*.

καὶ ἰδοὺ ἔκραξαν

λέγοντες·

Τί ἡμῖν καὶ σοί, υἱὲ τοῦ θεοῦ;

ἦλθες ὧδε πρὸ καιροῦ

βασανίσαι ἡμᾶς; (Matt 8:29)

ἐὰν εἴπωμεν

ὅτι οὐχ ἡμαρτήκαμεν,

ψεύστην ποιοῦμεν αὐτόν (1 John 1:8)

9. Apart from their use in indirect discourse, substantival clauses may be kept on the same line as the clause to which they belong or be indented on their own line. (Relative clauses that lack an antecedent are considered here as substantival clauses.) In deciding whether to separate a substantival clause, it is helpful to consider whether you would treat it as its own proposition in your DA. For example, although ὃν εἶπον in John 1:15 could be indented as its own clause, it is reasonable to take it with οὗτος ἦν as a single proposition, “This was the one about whom I said.” Thus the two clauses may be kept on the same line in the text flow:

οὗτος ἦν ὃν εἶπον

Rather than

οὗτος ἦν

ὃν εἶπον

10. Dependent clauses that *interrupt* independent clauses are “embedded clauses.” Leave them where they are. Put parentheses () around them. If you wish, you can also italicize them, or change the text color. But do not change the word order of the text.
- a. Here is an example of a subordinate relative clause embedded between the subject and the verb:

καὶ ἰδοὺ ὁ ἀστήρ, (ὃν εἶδον ἐν τῇ ἀνατολῇ), προῆγεν αὐτούς. (Matt 2:9)

- b. You may mark embedded adverbial participles as you would embedded clauses. Here is an example of an embedded relative clause within an embedded adverbial

participial (see **bold** below). You can distinguish them by using parentheses for the first and brackets for the second:

ἄχρι ἣς ἡμέρας (**ἐντειλάμενος τοῖς ἀποστόλοις διὰ πνεύματος ἁγίου**
[οὗς ἐξελέξατο]) ἀνελήμφθη. (Acts 1:2)

11. Use single space, but *add a blank line* before each *new sentence*.

Example 1: Text Flow of Matthew 8:23–29

²³Καὶ ἐμβάντι αὐτῷ εἰς τὸ πλοῖον
ἠκολούθησαν αὐτῷ οἱ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ.

²⁴καὶ ἰδοὺ σεισμὸς μέγας ἐγένετο ἐν τῇ θαλάσῃ,
ὥστε τὸ πλοῖον καλύπτεσθαι ὑπὸ τῶν κυμάτων,
αὐτὸς δὲ ἐκάθευδεν.

²⁵καὶ προσελθόντες
ἤγειραν αὐτὸν
λέγοντες·
Κύριε, σῶσον,
ἀπολλύμεθα.

²⁶καὶ λέγει αὐτοῖς·
Τί δειλοί ἐστε, ὀλιγόπιστοι;

τότε ἐγερθεὶς
ἐπετίμησεν τοῖς ἀνέμοις καὶ τῇ θαλάσῃ,
καὶ ἐγένετο γαλήνη μεγάλη.

²⁷οἱ δὲ ἄνθρωποι ἐθαύμασαν
λέγοντες·
Ποταπὸς ἐστὶν οὗτος
ὅτι καὶ οἱ ἄνεμοι καὶ ἡ θάλασσα αὐτῷ ὑπακούουσιν;

²⁸Καὶ ἐλθόντος αὐτοῦ εἰς τὸ πέραν εἰς τὴν χώραν τῶν Γαδαρηνῶν
ὑπῆντησαν αὐτῷ δύο δαιμονιζόμενοι (ἐκ τῶν μνημείων ἐξερχόμενοι) χαλεποὶ λίαν,
ὥστε μὴ ἰσχύειν τινὰ παρελθεῖν διὰ τῆς ὁδοῦ ἐκείνης.

²⁹καὶ ἰδοὺ ἔκραξαν
λέγοντες·
Τί ἡμῖν καὶ σοί, υἱὲ τοῦ θεοῦ;

ἦλθες ὥδε πρὸ καιροῦ
βασανίσαι ἡμᾶς;

Example 2: Text Flow of 1 John 1:5-10

⁵Καὶ ἔστιν αὕτη ἡ ἀγγελία
ἣν ἀκηκόαμεν ἀπ' αὐτοῦ
καὶ ἀναγγέλλομεν ὑμῖν,
ὅτι ὁ θεὸς φῶς ἐστίν
καὶ σκοτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν οὐδεμία.

⁶ἐὰν εἴπωμεν
ὅτι κοινωνίαν ἔχομεν μετ' αὐτοῦ
καὶ ἐν τῷ σκότει περιπατοῦμεν,
ψευδόμεθα
καὶ οὐ ποιοῦμεν τὴν ἀλήθειαν·
⁷ἐὰν ἐν τῷ φωτὶ περιπατοῦμεν,
ὥς αὐτός ἐστιν ἐν τῷ φωτί,
κοινωνίαν ἔχομεν μετ' ἀλλήλων,
καὶ τὸ αἶμα Ἰησοῦ τοῦ υἱοῦ αὐτοῦ καθαρίζει ἡμᾶς ἀπὸ πάσης ἁμαρτίας.

⁸ἐὰν εἴπωμεν
ὅτι ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἔχομεν,
ἐαυτοὺς πλανῶμεν
καὶ ἡ ἀλήθεια οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν ἡμῖν.

⁹ἐὰν ὁμολογῶμεν τὰς ἁμαρτίας ἡμῶν,
πιστός ἐστιν καὶ δίκαιος,
ἵνα ἀφῇ ἡμῖν τὰς ἁμαρτίας
καὶ καθάρσιν ἡμᾶς ἀπὸ πάσης ἀδικίας.

¹⁰ἐὰν εἴπωμεν
ὅτι οὐχ ἡμαρτήκαμεν,
ψεύστην ποιοῦμεν αὐτόν,
καὶ ὁ λόγος αὐτοῦ οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν ἡμῖν.

How to go from a Text Flow to Discourse Analysis

A Text Flow is a tool that makes simple *grammatical* distinctions. Discourse Analysis is a tool for making *semantic* distinctions. A “clause” is a grammatical category that we identify in a Text Flow. It is made up of other grammatical units (i.e., “subject” and “predicate”). A “proposition” is a semantic category that we identify in Discourse Analysis. It is made up of other semantic units (i.e., “topic” and “comment,” each of which are “concepts”). What is important to understand for Discourse Analysis is that *most* propositions are put into written communication in the form of clauses. For example, the idea (or the “proposition”) that your car is red may be communicated in a written *clause* “my car is red.” One clause usually correlates to one proposition.

However, sometimes an author can communicate a proposition in a grammatical unit that is *smaller* than a clause, like a *phrase* (i.e., an adjectival phrase or a prepositional phrase). For example, the two ideas (propositions) that I drink orange juice and that I do so for the sake of God’s glory may be communicated by the one written clause “I drink orange juice to God’s glory.” In this case, we say that “I drink orange juice” is the **explicit** proposition (because it is a complete clause), and we say that “[I drink] to God’s glory” is the **implicit** proposition (because we have to add a verb to make it a clause). Therefore, we move from a TF to a DA in three steps:

- 1) Translate each line (i.e., clause) identified in the TF
 - a. You have now identified the *explicit propositions*
- 2) Then, identify and put each *implicit proposition* on its own line as well. As you translate, you will naturally recognize certain phrases smaller than a clause that communicate whole ideas and make a logical contribution to the passage (e.g., “...for the praise of God’s glory,” or “...in Christ,” or “...along with her very own beloved sister”).
 - a. Sometimes a Greek phrase will naturally translate into an English clause. This is evidence that a whole proposition was packed into that phrase.
 - i. E.g., the adjectival phrase in ὁ πιστεύων εἰς τὸν κύριον ἀνὴρ λέγει is translated into English with a relative clause: “The man who believes in the Lord speaks.” In this case, you could identify two propositions like this:
 1. The man speaks
 2. [that is, the man] who believes in the Lord [speaks].
 - ii. **However**, in complicated cases like this, you may feel free to simplify the propositions into one: “The man who believes in the Lord speaks.”
 - b. Distinctions in semantics are just as “real” as those in grammar, but they are sometimes more vague or ambiguous. Therefore, DA involves not only observation, but *interpretation*. It is not always clear-cut. The processes of identifying propositions and naming their logical relationships have rules grounded in how semantics work, but DA (like exegesis in general) is just as much of an “art” as it is a “science.”
- 3) Place brackets and identify logical relationships, using Beale’s *Interpretive Lexicon*.